CHELSEA HALLFORD

CHIEF OF STAFF | AI-NATIVE OPERATIONS
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SUMMARY

Chief of Staff and operator-builder with 15+ years driving strategy, operations, and revenue for C-level leaders in high-growth tech and cloud consulting — more than a decade of it as a de facto chief of staff, including a $5M partner-alliances book, before formally owning the mandate. I build the operating system of an AI-native startup and scale through systems and AI instead of headcount — carrying revenue, recruiting, and finance/HR alongside the core mandate.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Chief of Staff · Business Operations · Strategy & Planning · Revenue Operations · Corporate Development · Partner Alliances · GTM & Productization · Talent & Recruiting · Finance & HR Operations · Board & Executive Cadence · AI-Leveraged Operations

EXPERIENCE

CHIEF OF STAFF

Kamiwaza (AI-native startup) *Mar 2025 – Present*

- **Built and run the company's operating system** — the weekly executive cadence, Big Rocks priority-tracking framework, and reporting discipline that give leadership a consistent pulse across every function.
- **Re-architected the role around AI:** designed and deployed 6 AI agents plus standing automations — continuous inbox triage, a Slack/Drive tracker that captures and actions CEO task assignments, and event-to-calendar sync — compressing hours of manual executive work into minutes.
- **Deployed Claude Co-work for seed-round due diligence,** auditing NDAs/MNDAs across HubSpot, Google Drive, email, and Adobe — collapsing days of manual searching into hours and surfacing missing agreements immediately.
- **Building auto-generated executive dashboards and briefings** from structured data and AI note-taking — targeting an 80%-automated weekly CEO briefing so leadership time goes to strategy, not status.
- **Carried the lighthouse enterprise account end-to-end** — technical scoping, partner integrations, and live field testing — then productized it into a repeatable offering: $200K baseline + $50K add-on nodes, with a path to ~$500K/year per customer.
- **Stood up recruiting from scratch:** sourced an ex-Meta recruiter who delivered a principal-level offer within one week; standardized interview, evaluation, and compensation frameworks and drove time-to-offer toward a sub-30-day target.
- **Own the hard people and org-design calls** founders often avoid — synthesizing documented feedback into structured, fair performance-improvement and separation paths.
- **Standing up the finance & HR back office:** ran a PEO/HRIS selection (ADP vs. Workday) with Drata compliance integration and cleared month-end close and banking blockers to make financials investor-ready.

EXECUTIVE BUSINESS PARTNER — DE FACTO CHIEF OF STAFF

Sumo Logic *Nov 2023 – Mar 2025*

- Trusted thought partner to three+ C-level executives — functioned as a de facto chief of staff, driving full-company initiatives and competing priorities across global time zones.
- Surfaced cross-functional alignment gaps across the leadership team and corrected them — connecting executives to their orgs and keeping stalled initiatives moving.
- Owned board and leadership offsite strategy, pre-reads, and execution; restructured executive time and operating cadence to protect focus on the company's biggest bets.

PARTNER ALLIANCES MANAGER

AllCloud (cloud consulting firm) *2021 – Jun 2023*

- Carried a $5M book of closed business tied to the partner ecosystem — owning the alliances revenue engine of a global cloud-consulting practice.
- Built and ran the alliances motion end-to-end: co-selling, joint pipeline, and partner-sourced deals across AWS, Salesforce, and Snowflake, plus the executive relationships behind them.

- Owned global partner events with ACV tracking in Salesforce (Dreamforce, AWS re:Invent, 200-person programs) — converting sponsorships into an $8M open pipeline.

EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT TO THE CEO — DE FACTO CHIEF OF STAFF

AllCloud (cloud consulting firm) *2018 – 2021*

- Partnered with the CEO as a thought leader and de facto chief of staff — running full-company initiatives well beyond the EA remit and pushing company objectives forward.
- Led initiatives across the direct-report leadership team, surfacing cross-functional alignment gaps and correcting them before they stalled execution.
- Owned the Board of Directors rhythm — off-sites, meetings, and presentations — alongside global calendar and travel strategy for the CEO.

EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT TO MULTIPLE C-LEVEL EXECUTIVES

Crocs *2016 – 2018*

- Project-led cross-functional initiatives spanning two departments — owning Board materials and driving the movement of goods from overseas factories to the U.S.
- Became the operator leadership relied on to move fast on complex global logistics and travel — clearing visa processing in as little as two days.

EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT TO CEO

Faction Inc. *2012 – 2016*

- Operated well beyond the EA title — led a $500K office remodel and relocation on time and under budget, and owned all internal and external company events.
- Ran HR operations (benefits, onboarding) and served as in-house creative, acting as a one-person operations, people, and brand function for the CEO.

ESTATE MANAGER & EA TO THE PRESIDENT

Li & Fung *2009 – 2012*

- Served as the "eyes and ears" for a blind President — EA, global travel coordinator, and estate manager.
- Coordinated schedules with Calvin Klein, John Varvatos, Tommy Hilfiger, and Stevie Wonder; led fundraising for his Foundation Fighting Blindness charity.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & automation — Claude, AI agents, Claude Co-work, prompt design, workflow automation · HubSpot & Salesforce CRM, Pardot · 3x AWS accredited · Drata, ADP / Workday (HRIS & PEO) · Google Workspace · Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook · Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, WordPress

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- Adaptive ski instructor — 5 years teaching adults and kids with adaptive needs in Vail, Colorado.
- Home mixologist — hosted virtual cocktail parties for partners during COVID-19.